



TONY FEDER

Patrick McCaughey with Big Mum

At McCaughey's gallery you can come without shoes but bring your ears

Patrick McCaughey is passionate about bow ties, fanatical about art and doesn't mind saying a few words. KEITH DUNSTAN reports.

IS Patrick McCaughey more successful than football? There is a reasonable argument to suggest he is. Victorian Football League attendances are sinking woefully. Patrick's are soaring splendidly. Patrick, when he has a good exhibition running, averages 30,000 to 35,000

visitors a week at his National Gallery in St Kilda Road, Melbourne. Already you are growling heatedly that the VFL can average 120,000 to 140,000 a week.

But wait a minute. He is still doing better than any individual football paddock; we are not taking in any other galleries and he does it all the year round. Could it be that, here in Melbourne, deep down we are more interested in Tiepolo, McCubbin, Nolan and Boyd than Silvagni, Salmon, Matthews and Schimmelbusch?

Patrick McCaughey believes deeply that we are heading this way. He is four years down the track as director of the National Gallery of Victoria and he has just been appointed visiting professor of Australian studies at Harvard for 1986-87. He will follow such august citizens as Gough Whitlam, Manning Clark, Geoffrey Blainey and Dame Leonie Kramer. He will be away for nine months. Nine months without